

Abdullah Al Zahid

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September 30, 2026

Talent Acquisition

Integrated Delivery — Commercial Management, Fleet Strategy
Metrolinx, 20 Bay Street

Re: Senior Advisor, Commercial Strategy, Rail (Job ID 117225)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to be considered for the Senior Advisor, Commercial Strategy, Rail position with the Fleet Strategy team. I worked at Metrolinx in 2023 on the rail operations side, and I am now an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto, where much of my work is the analysis and communication this role describes.

A large part of the posting is about preparing presentations and briefing materials for senior management, drafting and reviewing memos and briefing notes, and keeping information flowing between a business unit and its stakeholders. That is a daily part of my current job. I write the briefing notes, memos and presentations that carry findings to managers across divisions, and I coordinate with consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose interests do not always line up, which often means putting a position in writing that has to hold up with more than one audience.

The posting also asks for experience with key performance indicators and for improving processes that are not working. I built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which brought several years of data from separate sources into one validated source the division reports from and replaced a report that was rebuilt by hand. At Metrolinx my work meant establishing what proposed operating changes would do to run times, equipment and schedule, which gave me some sense of how the fleet and operating sides of a railway depend on each other. I also worked on how that analysis was produced: I built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that summarised speed profiles and run-time variance from large operations files, and set up a command line workflow that cut turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

I should be clear about the commercial side. I have not administered commercial contracts, monitored contractor compliance, managed claims or developed negotiation mandates, and my knowledge of contract law is general. I have not managed a budget, and I have not used Oracle or Unifier. The analytical, reporting and communication parts of the role I would bring from the start; the contract discipline I would be learning.

Thank you for taking the time to consider my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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